

X6 Pro by a huge margin. The same pattern is repeated in both the GeekBench Single-Core and Multi-Core tests. In PCMark Work, its score is very close to the POCO X6 Pro, which proves it is capable of handling day-to-day tasks with ease.

In GPU benchmarks, the phone does a good job and outperforms the Samsung Galaxy A35 and OPPO Reno11 in 3D Mark Wildlife and GFXBench tests by a convincingly wide margin. However, the OnePlus Nord CE4 with the same chipset beats its GPU scores. So, when it comes to objective tests, the Motorola Edge 50 Pro finds itself somewhere in the middle of the pack. However, my daily usage experience was extremely smooth in most cases. I only faced some lag and random app shut-downs in the camera app – specifically when using Portrait Mode. Additionally, I did experience some frame drops while gaming, particularly after 15-20 minutes of continuous play.

As for the UI, Motorola has bid adieu to MyUX in favour of the new Hello UI. This is based on the latest Android 14 and Motorola has promised three years of OS updates and four years of security updates, which is pretty impressive for the price. The design has been completely overhauled with new fonts, colours and icons. In my opinion, the new UI looks a bit childish but they've added tons of utility and customisation options, which is a plus.

Additionally, there's no bloatware in the form of third-party apps – only some pre-installed Moto and Google apps. You also get access to some Motorola-specific features such as Moto Unplugged, Moto Secure, Smart Connect, and Family Space.

CAMERA

As I mentioned before, Motorola is generating a lot of buzz about the Motorola Edge 50 Pro having the world's first Pantone-validated camera. The phone also bagged the Pantone SkinTone Validation and has added an array of AI-assisted camera features. A fully loaded camera configuration, but does it impress? It's a mixed bag.

Let's start with the good. The phone's camera definitely impresses with its crisp photos in both daylight and low light.

The detail retention is solid, especially in low-light conditions given the wide f/1.4 aperture which pulls in plenty of light. The dynamic range, however, is a bit of a hit-or-miss. The highlights are usually well-exposed but shadows are slightly crushed. Additionally, against direct sunlight, there are some serious HDR blooming issues when clicking pictures of human subjects. The colour reproduction leans towards the reds, with high contrast levels.

In portrait images, the Indian skin tones are not well-represented. They always come off looking more orange or red than reality. The edge detection is decent but does miss a stray hair or two at times. One gripe in my portrait mode is the inability to shoot with the dedicated 3x telephoto shooter. The phone allows 24mm, 35mm, 50mm, and 85mm focal length portrait shots, but none of these leverage the telephoto shooter. General 3x shots from the telephoto lens have a noticeable colour shift compared to the primary lens too.

The 13 MP ultrawide camera clicks good shots in daylight, but the detail levels take a hit in comparison to the primary lens but the colour consistency with the primary camera is good. There is slight distortion at the edges of the ultrawide photos though. Macro pictures are quite impressive since the 13 MP shooter has autofocus. The phone has a 50 MP selfie camera which generally produces well-exposed, detailed pictures, but there were some instances where the exposure levels were a bit too high.

The phone does introduce some AI camera features such as AI Photo Enhancement Engine, Smart Motion Capture, Smart Colour Segmentation, and more. However, I think Motorola needs to focus on fixing the camera tuning on priority instead of gunning hard for more AI features. Hopefully, the camera inconsistencies can be fixed via an OTA update; we'll keep you updated here.

BATTERY LIFE

The Motorola Edge 50 Pro has decent battery life – not the worst we've seen, but certainly not the best. In my usage, I got about 4-5 hours of screen-on time, which

is a bit underwhelming. However, if you're not a heavy user, you should be able to get to the end of the day with some juice to spare. In our 4K video loop test where we played a 4K video on VLC on loop, the phone lasted a little over 13 hours. In contrast, the OnePlus Nord CE4 lasted nearly double the time.

As for charging, if you're lucky enough to get the 125 W charger in the box, the phone charges from zero to full in merely 23 minutes, which is blazing fast.

VERDICT

The Motorola Edge 50 Pro is a nearly perfect mid-range smartphone. For the features on offer such as IP68 dust and water resistance, 50 W wireless charging, and a 144 Hz pOLED display, it has been priced competitively starting at merely ₹31,999. The Motorola Edge 50 Pro also has one of the most gorgeous designs on the market in its price segment – the colour-matched aluminium frame, the soft vegan back, and the delightful colour choices make it a treat for the eyes. You also get a colour-accurate display, decent performance, and super fast 125 W charging speeds. However, the camera experience is a chink in its armour. The camera array, while impressive, hasn't been tuned exceptionally well leading to some issues with skin tones and general colour reproduction. The slower UFS 2.2 storage and frame drops during heavy gamers are minor complaints I have with the phone as well. However, if Motorola fixes the camera issues, the Motorola Edge 50 Pro could very well be the perfect mid-range smartphone in India.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 720 | OS: Hello UI, Android 14 | Camera: 50 MP + 10 MP + 13 MP | Front Camera: 50 MP | Video: Up to 4K at 30fps (front and rear) | Display: 6.7" OLED, 1220 x 2712 pixels, 144 Hz, 1B colours | Battery capacity: 4,500 mAh | Charging: 125 W (wired), 50 W (wireless), 10 W (reverse wireless) | IP rating: IP68 | Weight: 186 g | Colours: Luxe Lavender, Black Beauty, Moonlight Pearl

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